

Dhruv Nirmal

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a commercial and procurement analyst at a procurement analytics consultancy, where supplier, spend, pricing and tender analysis is the core of the work. I've run a pricing engagement that helped a restaurant chain find around **A\$2M** in savings, evaluated supplier tenders across food, drink and packaging, and structured roughly **A\$12B** of spend for supplier evaluation. I work mainly in Excel, SQL and Python (pandas, scikit-learn, Prophet), with Power BI and Tableau for reporting.

KEY SKILLS

Commercial & Procurement: supplier tender / RFP evaluation, supplier performance and pricing analysis, margin / COGS / GP%, category cost analysis, supplier negotiation support, business cases

Excel, BI & Reporting: advanced Excel, Power BI, Tableau, dashboard design, KPI reporting

Inventory & Forecasting: demand forecasting (Prophet), bill of materials, par-level reorder alerts, stock planning

Data & Modelling: Python (pandas, numpy, scikit-learn), SQL, time-series forecasting, ML classification

EXPERIENCE

Commercial Analyst, Purchasing Index Data Analytics (Comprara Group)

Jun 2024 to Present | Melbourne, Australia

A procurement analytics consultancy. I own client engagements end to end: framing the problem, building the analysis, and presenting to procurement and finance stakeholders. Selected engagements:

Pricing and margin analytics: multi-venue restaurant group (AU/NZ)

- Problem: the client's supply costs were high, but they couldn't see where margin was leaking.
- Approach: owned the account as sole analyst; built a ~3,000-item product catalogue, a pricing-decision dashboard tracking price movement and cost leakage by product, venue and supplier (Python, pandas, SQL), and a second dashboard flagging cheaper substitute items; presented to the Chief Procurement Officer and category managers in bi-weekly reviews.
- Result: around 30% savings, roughly **A\$2M** over a year, in their largest category, used directly in supplier negotiations.

Supplier tender evaluations: food, drink and packaging

- Problem: clients needed a like-for-like read on competing supplier tenders to award the right supplier.
- Approach: evaluated tenders for the restaurant chain (chicken and spirits supply) and a fresh-produce client (fruit and packaging), comparing bids on price and terms.
- Result: gave each client a clear, comparable basis for the award decision across categories.

ML spend classification: enterprise procurement client (~A\$12B spend)

- Problem: categorising the client's five-year, roughly **A\$12B** spend book was manual and took an account manager over a month per cycle.
- Approach: led the firm's first ML classifier to automate it: a one-vs-all model keeping high-value spend on manual review and modelling the long tail; scikit-learn, TF-IDF (moving to embeddings), LogisticRegression with class weights, GridSearchCV cross-validation.

- Result: cut the cycle from over a month to a single day's run, and gave category managers a clean base for supplier evaluation.

Inventory forecasting and stock planning: fresh-produce and medical clients

- Problem: clients needed to plan what to order and hold, and avoid stockouts.
- Approach: built a Prophet model forecasting raw-material and chemical inventory three months ahead with external regressors (sea-freight trends); a bill of materials mapping products to their inputs; and automated daily and weekly inventory reports with par-level reorder alerts.
- Result: forecasts within a 12.5 to 14% error margin; the inventory reports are used day to day for stock decisions.

Data Engineer Intern, Victorian Centre for Data Insights (VCDI)

Aug 2023 to Nov 2023 | Melbourne, Australia

- Built a distributed anomaly-detection pipeline (Databricks, PySpark) on government procurement data, improving detection accuracy by about 20%, and delivered a Power BI solution adopted by senior Department of Transport stakeholders.

PROJECTS

Facit: F&B Profitability SaaS for Independent Cafes

- Built a multi-tenant SaaS unifying POS, wages and 14 suppliers' invoices into a weekly read on food cost %, gross margin, menu engineering and supplier price-creep. Live with a St Kilda café as the design partner.

EDUCATION

Master of Data Science, Monash University | Feb 2022 to Dec 2023

Bachelor of Engineering, Thapar University | May 2017 to May 2021